III. Academic Year

The Academic Year shall be computed as the two semesters and the following intersession (formerly summer term) of the school year. For those who do not take intersession classes, the academic year shall be computed for the two semesters of the school year.

IV. Study Load of Undergraduate Students

A. **Regular Student Study Load.** The normal study load of regular students is the number of units prescribed by the curriculum in which the student is enrollled in. A student is considered full time or carrying a full load when he carries all subjects prescribed in his curriculum for a particular school semester. Students should follow the study load prescribed by their curricula or as assigned and approved by their respective Deans.

B. **Probation Study Load.** Students on probation are to carry a minimum study load of 15 units and a maximum of 18 units per semester.

C. **Working Student Study Load.** Working students are limited to a study load of 15 units per semester. However, the Dean may use his/her discretion to allow a somewhat heavier load which should be less than the full-time/regular load of the student's curriculum.

D. **Graduating Student's Study Load.** During the last semester of senior year, a graduating student may be permitted, upon request, to carry a load of three to six units in excess of the regular load, considering the academic standing of the student and upon the recommendation of the College Dean.

E. **Intersession Study Load.** A graduate or undergraduate student shall carry a maximum of nine units of work, provided that the student shall carry not more than one laboratory subject, unless otherwise required or prescribed by the curriculum.

F. **Credits for Study Load.** To be given credit, all study loads must be explicitly approved by the Dean of the college concerned.

V. Class Related Regulations

The unit of instruction used for computing the amount of work required for graduation is the semester hour. One semester hour is equivalent to an hour's lecture or recitation per week for one semester. A semester consists of 18 weeks. Hours corresponding to units for laboratory work may vary. Regular attendance in all classes and laboratory sessions is one of the most important obligations of the student. Students are expected to attend all scheduled exercises of their classes.

A. Cuts, Absences, Lateness

1. Attendance record (including absences and lateness) is recorded by the teacher.
2. There shall be no excused absences. Any reconsideration or special cases shall be decided by the teacher.
3. Overcuts. Once the maximum number of absences is surpassed (see tables a-c), the student is over cut and is automatically dropped and given a mark of AF for the course.
    a) Lectures
    - For 1 unit, with 1 meeting per week, 1 hour of meeting, anf 4 maximum number of absences incurred.
    - For 2 units, with 1 meeting per week, 2 hours of meeting, and 4 maximum number of absences incurred.

- For 3 units, with 1 meeting per week, 3 hours of meeting, and 4 maximum number of absences incurred.
- For 3 units, with 2 meetings per week, 1.5 hours of meeting, and 8 maximum number of absences incurred.
- For 4 units, with 2 meetings per week, 2 hours of meeting, and 8 maximum number of absences incurred.
- For 4 units, with 4 meetings per week, 1 hour of meeting, and 15 maximum number of absences incurred.
- For 5 units, with 4 meetings per week, 1.25 hours of meeting, and 15 maximum number of absences incurred.
- For 6 units, with 4 meetings per week, 1.5 hours of meeting, and 15 maximum number of absences incurred.

b) Laboratory Sessions

- For 1 unit, with 1 meeting per week, 3 hours of meeting, and 4 maximum number of absences incurred.
- For 2 units, with 2 meetings per week, 3 hours of meeting, and 8 maximum number of absences incurred.

c) Intersession

- If the subject/course credit is 3 units, with a schedule of class meetings of Monday to Friday, will have 6 maximum number of absences incurred.
- If the subject/course credit is 2 units, with a schedule of class meetings of Monday to Friday (for 4 weeks), will have 4 maximum number of absences incurred.
- If the subject/course credit is 2 units, with a schedule of class meetings of 4 times a week (for 5 weeks), will have 4 maximum number of absences incurred.
- If the subject/course credit is 2 units, with a schedule of class meetings of 3 times a week (double period) for 4 weeks, will have 2 maximum number of absences incurred.
- If the subject/course credit is 1 unit, with a schedule of class meetings of Once a week (double period), will have 1 maximum number of absences incurred.
- If the subject/course credit is 6 units, with a schedule of class meetings of Monday to Friday (double period), will have 6 maximum number of absences incurred.
- If the subject/course credit is 5 units, with a schedule of class meetings of Monday toThursday (double period) and Friday (single period), will have 5 maximum number of absences incurred.

4. Lateness may be counted as an absence if the student comes in later than 10 minutes (for 1 hour classes), 15 minutes (for 1.5 hour classes), 30 minutes (for 3 hour classes) from the start of session.
5. Three accumulated lateness is equivalent to 1 absence.
6. Students may be allowed to leave the classroom with the permission of the teacher. The student must be back within 5 minutes, otherwise s/he shall be considered absent.
7. Class hours lost by late registration are considered absences.

8. Attendance is not an explicit part of the XU Grading System. However, students still need to comply with class attendance requirements for them to pass the subject. (CMO 40, Series 2008, Article 22, Section 107)
9. There are existing CHED regulations on absences during intersession courses which the University upholds.

B. Class Beadle System and Seating Arrangement

Teachers should appoint a class beadle and assistant class beadle and must be given specific
instructions about their functions such as:
1. Assist in monitoring the attendance of the class;
2. Turn o` lights and fans after the class;
3. Enforce class discipline when the teacher does not arrive at the prescribed time (e.g. noise management);
4. Dismiss the class when the teacher still does not arrive after the lapse of time (10 minutes for 1 hour classes, 15 minutes for 1.5 hour classes, 30 minutes for 3 hour classes); and
5. Report the teacher's absence to the Dean's Office.

For better classroom management, teachers should assign students a particular seat. Seat plan (forms) are downloadable through www.xu.edu.ph.

C. Bell System

For 1st Bell: Composed of three successive rings, means the current class should be dismissed
For 2nd Bell: Composed of two successive rings, serves as clearance time for teachers and students to transfer to their next classroom.
For 3rd Bell: Composed of 1 ring, signals the start of the next class.

VI. Examinations, Marks and Quality Point Index (QPI)

A. **Periodic Examinations.** Besides regular class quizzes, four oMcial general examinations are given every term: preliminary, mid-term, semi-final and final examinations. The dates of which are indicated on the academic calendar. The schedule for each subject is announced to the students usually two weeks before the examinations.

B. **Admit to Examination Card.** A student is not allowed to take any oMcial examination unless s/he presents his/her Admit-to-Exam Card duly stamped as "cleared" by the Finance Office. A student using tampered examination permit or one not belonging to him/her will be punished severely with suspension or expulsion.

C. **Examination Booklets/Answer Sheets.** A student must use the oMcial examination booklet of the University or the prescribed answer sheets distributed by the proctor during an examination.

D. **Removal Examination.** Absolutely no removal examination will be given to a student.

E. **Final Examination Exemption.** Deserving students, whose pre-final cumulative grade is A, may be exempted from final examination. Upon

exemption, the student will automatically earn a final grade of A. Exemption from final examination is a privilege and not a right of the student.

F. Delayed Examinations

1. All students who fail to take final examinations shall be given a grade of Incomplete (INC). This incomplete mark should be removed. The deadline of compliance of INCs and the submission of Delayed Grades across all undergraduate programs will be twenty-five (25) days after the end of each term. If the INC is not removed within this period, the mark will be automatically changed to F (Failure).
2. Delayed prelim, midterm and semi-final examinations are left to the discretion of the teacher. No examination fee shall be collected.
3. The student has to apply for delayed final examination and pay the required examination fee as prescribed by the Finance OMce.
4. The application for delayed final examination shall be approved by the College Dean of the student. The Dean shall ascertain the reasons why the student failed to take the final examination. S/he shall indicate on the student's application if the reason is valid or not. Considered valid reasons are: a) tuition fees not paid on time; b) student was sick; c) urgent personal concerns such as death or serious illness of immediate family. Documentary evidences shall be required. Reasons other than these shall be considered invalid.
5. The administration of delayed final exams should follow the prescribed schedule. If this is not possible, the student arranges the schedule with the faculty. For delayed prelims, midterms and semi-finals, the student arranges the schedule with the faculty and only for valid reasons as stated above.
6. If the reason for the delayed final exam is valid, the results of the final examinations shall be used in the computation of the student's final grade.
7. If the reason for the delayed final exam is invalid, the student is given sanction in the form of point deduction. Only 80% of the final examination score shall be used in the computation of the final grade.

G. Grading System and QPI Requirements

1. QPI System. The student's promotion, graduation, honors or separation from the College is determined by whether or not s/he has satisfied the QPI requirements for a given academic year which consists of two semesters and the following intersession.
2. The QPI of a student is computed by:
    a) Multiplying the quality point value of the letter marks in each course by the number of units/credits in the course; and
    b) Adding the products and then dividing the sum by the total number of units taken during the academic semester or year.
3. NSTP marks are not included in QPI computations but must be passing marks.
4. Transfer credits from other schools (academic units taken from other schools but credited in XU) are also not included in the computation of QPI.

5. Credits earned from subjects which are not in the student's curriculum but aligned with the student's program of study are included in the computation of the QPI.

H. Marking System

The mark of the student is computed at the end of the term and is based on quizzes, long tests, oMcial examinations, homework and/or assignments, periodical tests, recitations, projects and where appropriate, also on practicum. Academic achievement is marked in the following manner:

- If grade is "A", the QPI is 4, range in 92-100 percentage, which means "Excellent".
- If grade is "A-", the QPI is 3.5, range in 84-91.99 percentage, which means "Very Good".
- If grade is "B", the QPI is 3, range in 76-83.99 percentage, which means "Good".
- If grade is "B-", the QPI is 2.5, range in 68-75.99 percentage, which means "Fair".
- If grade is "C", the QPI is 2, range in 60-67.99 percentage, which means "Satisfactory".
- If grade is "D", the QPI is 1, range in 50-59.99 percentage, which means "Passed".
- If grade is "F/AF", the QPI is 0, range in below 50 percentage, which means "Failed".

Professional subjects in competency-based programs follow a 60% or C passing grade.
The descriptive equivalents of the letter marks are as follows:

A Excellent - The student demonstrates mastery of the subject; has exceptional knowledge of the field and complete facility in the application of its principles.

A- Very Good - The student displays broad general competence in the field; has facility in dealing with both major and minor areas of the subject.

B Good - The student demonstrates a good understanding of the principles of the field; is able to integrate course material with knowledge acquired elsewhere in an average manner.

B- Fair - The student has an average grasp of both major and minor principles and shows insight into relationships between topics.

C Satisfactory - The student shows understanding of the major topics of the field; is generally competent in the course skills.

D Passed - The student demonstrates suMcient knowledge and skills to assure passing the next course in the sequence; shows minimal understanding of general principles.

F Failed - Failure.

Other marks given and entered in the academic records are:

INC Incomplete - In extraordinary circumstances, when some weighty requirement of a course has not been met or the final examination has not been taken, the student will be given the temporary grade of INC (Incomplete). All INCs should be complied with within twenty-five (25) days after the end of the term. Otherwise, the grade will automatically be changed to F.
The INC mark is changed to a letter grade through this procedure:

1. Submission of the completed work or of the final examination result
2. Evaluation by the teacher and submission of letter grade to the Department Chair
3. Submission by Department Chair of the delayed grade to the Registrar through channels

W Withdrawn - Mark given to the student who withdraws enrollment from the subject/s with the approval of the College Dean, the Registrar and the Finance OMcer within the prescribed period. No quality point.

AF Failure Due to Excess Absences (Overcut) - Mark given to students who incur excessive absences and to those who unoMcially drop or withdraw from the course/s they have enrollled in. Quality point value: 0 (zero).

LOA Leave of Absence - This may be given to a student who files for LOA with the approval of the Dean, the Registrar, and the University Treasurer. No quality point.

I. Procedure for Request for Change of Mark:
    1. The last day for a Request to Change Final Marks will be thirty-seven (37) days after the end of each term.
    2. Acceptable reasons for request/appeal for change of mark include wrong computation of grades which may arise from mathematical error, wrong assignments of weights, basis of grade determination not the same as announced at the start of classes and clerical or typographical errors in entries. All other reasons for change of marks shall not be considered.
    3. The teacher is asked for his/her reply or recommendation through the Department. This is submitted to the Department Chair who gives his/her recommendation to the Standards Committee.
    4. After deliberation, the Committee endorses its recommendation to the Dean concerned through the Vice President for Higher Education (VPHED). The Dean sends action taken to the Registrar through VPHE.

All student academic grades upon submission of the schools' promotional report to CHED Regional. Office shall be considered final. (Ref CHED RM No. 005, s. 2019)

J. Curriculum Requirements
    1. A student of a baccalaureate degree is expected to graduate at the end of the prescribed curricular tenure of the program. Should a student overstay his/her tenure in the curriculum, s/he may be allowed to complete the course within ten years from start of his/her first curricular year upon the approval of CHED. On his/her seventh year, the student concerned writes a letter to CHED through channels. If the curriculum has been enriched/scrapped before a student graduates, s/he is allowed to take a related subject in lieu of the subject/s which may no longer be offered.
    2. A student is prescribed of the subjects scheduled for a particular semester/term in his/her curricular year. His/her curricular year level is based on the number of credits s/he has earned in the approved curriculum. S/he is promoted to the next curricular year level when s/he has earned no less than 75% of the required cumulative units prescribed for the previous curricular semester/s.

VII. Student Activities

Student activities are essential to balance the formation and development of the students. Each student should participate in activities to the extent that academic standing will follow. The University reserves the right to limit or suspend a student's participation in activities if they are found to be detrimental to his/her studies.

A. Membership in Organization

1. Currently enrolled sophomore, junior and senior undergraduate XU students may become members of student organizations. Freshmen, while not encouraged to join may choose to be observers of the organizations of their choice.
2. A student can be a member of only two (2) organizations of his/her choice not counting the CSG and College Council where s/he belongs.

B. OFF-Campus Activities

In many instances, students are allowed to conduct activities outside the University to enable them to achieve their goals and serve a valuable purpose. When students wish to conduct activity outside the University, they must accomplish the necessary permits which includes a signed parents/guardian's consent form and submit to the Office of Student Affairs five days before the actual off-campus activity.

C. Field Trips

Field trips in courses, if these are parts of the course, shall be scheduled on non-class days so as not to sacrifice other classes of the students concerned.

1. If a teacher wishes to bring students to field trips, he/she shall secure the permission of the Department Chair/Program Director (who judges relevance of the field trip to the course), the Dean (who judges the merits of the field trip vis-a-vis absences in other classes) and the Vice- President for Higher Education (who shall determine whether such trip does not pose liability to the school). The teacher ensures the safety and security of the students.
2. For travel outside the city requiring an overnight stay, students shall secure prior written permission of the parents or guardians.
3. Field trips which take the place of the regular teaching hours shall be reported to the Department Chair, the Dean and Vice-President for Higher Education in the Non-Regular Instructional Activities Form.
4. In deciding for field trips, the relevance of the field trip to the course, the classes the students will miss during the field trips and the safety of the students shall be considered.
5. Field trips undertaken as extra-curricular activities by student organizations are under the responsibility of the Director of Student Affairs.

D. Using the Name of the University

Students are allowed to represent the University/use the name of the University or any of its offices and affiliated units including recognized student organizations only when approval is granted by the office concerned. This may apply but may not be limited to joining competitions or gatherings and organizing activities/events outside the University.

E. Suspension of Activities

All student activities are suspended during prelim exams, one week prior to and during midterms, during semi-final exams and two weeks prior to and during final examinations.

(For detailed and comprehensive guidelines on student activities, please refer to a separate student organization manual available at the Office of Student Affairs.)

VIII. Scholastic Responsibility, Promotion and Separation from the University

(Application of the QPI System)

A. Scholastic Responsibility. Students enrollled in the University for a degree must achieve high academic performance. To be promoted or readmitted to the same program, the student must at least have an average scholastic standing.

B. Promotion

1. It is the student's responsibility to ascertain his/her academic standing at the end of each semester/school term by having himself/herself evaluated at the Dean's Office concerned.

2. For unconditional promotion to sophomore year, a regular (non-shiftee/non-transferee/non-returnee) freshmen must obtain a year's QPI of 1.50 or above at the end of the academic year.

Freshmen whose year's QPI falls below 1.20 will be ineligible for admission to Sophomore year.

Freshmen whose year's QPI is 1.20 or more but less than 1.50 may be admitted on probation to Sophomore year at the discretion of the Dean after consultation with the Standards Committee.

Students must write a letter of appeal if they desire this probation.

3. The required QPI at the end of Sophomore year for promotion to Junior year is 1.80.

4. The required QPI at the end of Junior year for promotion to Senior year is 2.00.

5. The required year's QPI at the end of the Fourth year for promotion to Fifth year in five-year courses is 2.00.

6. Sophomores whose year's QPI is 1.50 or more but less than 1.80 may be admitted on probation to Junior year at the discretion of the Dean after consultation with the Standards Committee.

Similarly, Juniors (and fourth-year students in five-year courses) may be admitted to the following year if their year's QPI is 1.70 or more but below 2.00 at the discretion of the Dean after consultation with the Standards Committee. The request must be done in writing.

7. The required year's QPI for Seniors or for Fifth Year students in five-year academic programs for eligibility for graduation is 2.00. Students whose senior year QPI (fifth year QPI for five-year academic programs) is lower than 2.00 may graduate with the XU Diploma if their cumulative QPI for their entire stay in the college at XU is 2.00 or higher. Students of the new curriculum who do not obtain the minimum 2.00 QPI requirement for graduation will not be issued a Certificate of Graduation e`ective SY 2021-2022.

8. A student who is on probation is given one year to lift his/her probation status. S/he should not take a leave during that year. Otherwise, s/he will be dropped from the college. In cases where a student is able to lift his/her probationary status after one semester but later fails to meet the required QPI for his/her year level and semester, s/he may be placed under probationary status again. A student shall not be placed under probation more than two times per academic program.

9. Students on probation shall have minimum and maximum loads of 15 and 18 academic units respectively for each semester. A student placed on probation shall be given the probation conditions in writing by the College Dean, signed by the student and a copy sent to the parents/guardians.

10. The academic evaluation of a student is made on a semestral basis. The QPI evaluation is made on a yearly basis.

C. Separation from the University

1. A student who has been dropped from the two academic programs shall be warned to improve his/her academic performance and move out of probationary status. Otherwise, s/he shall no longer be admitted by any unit in the University.

2. A student who has been dropped from three academic programs shall no longer be eligible for readmission or admission to any other program in the University.

IX. Graduation Requirements

A. Application for Graduation. A candidate for graduation is required to apply for evaluation of his/her records during the semester preceding his/her graduation so that any deficiency may be attended to. Dates and deadlines for this application are announced each semester by the University Registrar. Application for graduation is done online through the SLMIS. All applications for graduation must be recommended by the College Dean.

1. No student who has deficiency in any academic or non-academic requirement will be given permission to graduate.

2. All candidates for graduation must be present at the commencement rehearsals and exercises. A candidate for graduation may be excused from attending the graduation exercises for a good reason.

B. Diploma Requirements To receive the XU Diploma, the candidate must meet the following requirements:

1. The candidate must have satisfactorily complied with all the academic and non-academic requirements of the college s/he is enrollled in and the University.

2. The candidate must meet the required QPI of 2.00 for his final school/curricular year, e.g. the QPI of all courses, except NSTP (cf. VI.F.5.1), taken in the first and second semesters of the current school year including intersession (if any).

a.) If the candidate's final semester is the first semester of the current school year (prospective December graduate), the QPI of 2.00 is the QPI of the first and second semesters of the previous school year including intersession (if any), as well as the current first semester which ends in December.

b.) Alternative option in the computation of candidate's QPI: overall QPI of all school/curricular years or all semesters/terms of studies.

3. The candidate must have gained 50% of all units pertinent to his degree at XU.

4. The candidate must have had a residence at XU for at least 2 years or one full academic year (two semesters) plus four intersessions.

5. The candidate must have had settled all financial and property obligations to the University.

6. Theology and Philosophy Requirements. To obtain the XU Diploma, the candidate must have fulfilled the Theology and Philosophy requirements.

a. Theology Requirements

1.) All undergraduate students are required to enroll in and pass the core Theology prescribed in their respective curricula. Transferees are also bound by this requirement.

2.) Undergraduate transferees into Junior and Senior years must take the required Theology courses.

3.) All Christian Non-Catholic students normally follow the Protestant cluster of subjects. Certain Theology subjects, however, judged by the Chair of the Department to be common to all Christians may be selected from the core of Catholic Religion.

4.) Non-Christian students are required to take and pass the cluster of Theology subjects specified by the Theology Department, e.g. iTheo.

b. Philosophy Requirements

1.) All undergraduate students must enroll in and pass the units in Philosophy required by their respective curricula.

2.) Equivalent subjects explicitly designated by the Chair of the Philosophy Department may be accepted as Philosophy subjects.

3.) Transferees are not exempted from any Philosophy requirement. They may complete all government requirements but not receive a University diploma unless they can earn the required Philosophy credits.

7. The candidate must have not been found guilty of major violations of the Code of Conduct as specified in Chapter III of this Handbook.

8. Professional programs have their own policies in accordance with their specific CMO's.

X. Academic Honors and Awards

A. Dean's List. The minimum required study load for the granting of the Dean's List Award will be based on the regular load for a given year level for a specific program in a particular semester, regardless of the courses taken. The Dean's List Award will be given at the end of the first and the second semesters on the basis of QPI:

1. First honors are awarded to students with a semestral QPI of 3.70 and above.

2. Second honors are awarded to students with a semestral QPI of 3.35 or above but lower than 3.70.

B. Graduation Honors

1. To be eligible for graduation honors, a candidate must have completed all requirements for a diploma thereby earning at least 80% of the total academic requirements for graduation here at Xavier Ateneo; must not have been found guilty of any violations to the Code of Conduct as specified in Chapter III of the Student Handbook; and he/she must have no Failure (F) marks from all courses taken during the course of completing the program of study, including PE/PATH-FIT and NSTP, e`ective SY 2021-2022.

2. Students who graduate from more than one program may receive graduation honors only once.

3. To graduate **Summa Cum Laude**, a student must have a cumulative QPI of all academic units taken at XU of 3.80 or above.

4. To graduate **Magna Cum Laude**, a student must have a cumulative QPI of all academic units taken at XU of 3.60 or higher but lower than 3.80.

5. To graduate **Cum Laude**, a student must have a cumulative QPI of all academic units taken at XU of 3.40 or higher but lower than 3.60.

6. Students with QPI of 3.35 – 3.39 will be recognized and awarded with medal during the graduation rites e`ective SY 2021-2022 as **Honorable Mention**. The award will be indicated in the TOR and diploma.

7. Only units relevant to the program will be included in the computation of the required QPI for academic honors. Relevance of courses is decided upon by the Program Chair and the Dean. The excess units earned by the student will not be included in the computation of the required QPI for academic honors.

8. The student must complete the program within the prescribed duration.

C. Outstanding Graduate Awards. The Outstanding Graduate Award is given at commencement to an honor graduate (Summa Cum Laude, Magna Cum Laude, Cum Laude, Honorable Mention) of an undergraduate college for excellent performance in academic and superior contribution to promotion of values and ideals of XU. Criteria used are the following:

a. Academic achievement (including Honorable Mention)

b. Residency requirements (100% completion of all academic requirements at XU, emphasizing loyalty to XU)

c. Application of the same criteria in the selection of the Class Valedictorian

d. Selection committee should comprise at least five (5) members

Interviews and testimonial recommendations may be required. It may happen that a given college may not have an Outstanding Graduate Awardee. A Gold Medal is awarded to the Outstanding Graduate.

D. Class Valedictorian. The Class Valedictorian represents the graduating class and embodies the ideals of Jesuit Education at XU. S/he is chosen from among the outstanding student awardees of the different colleges following the criteria set by the Awards Committee. The Class Valedictorian shall speak on behalf of the graduates during Commencement Exercises.

A Gold Medal shall be given to him/her.

The choice of the Class Valedictorian is a prerogative of XU and no student can demand or claim it as a matter of right.

E. The Medal for Faber Award is given to the graduating student with the following eligibility requirements:

a. The student has exemplary service in the community as an expression of his/her faith (GC34)

b. Open to Catholics and non-Catholics (Spirit of Ecumenism)

c. The student has no grade below C but with a QPI requirement of at least 2.5

d. The student has satisfied all other requirements of XU Diploma

Only one Faber Medal is awarded for the entire University.

F. Loyalty Award. The Loyalty Award is a medal given to a graduating student who has completed all the regulatory and institutional academic requirements and is thereby eligible to receive her/his diploma indicating that she/he has successfully earned either a Bachelor's Degree (BS or BA), a Graduate Level Degree (Masters' or Doctorate), or a Professional Degree (Doctor of Medicine or Juris Doctor) after an unbroken academic residence at XU since Kindergarten. Except for purposes of participation in non-credit enrichment programs, any record of valid enrollment in any other academic or training institution is a ground for disqualification for the award.

XI. Standards Committee

The Standards Committee makes recommendations to the proper Dean on all questions related to the implementation of the academic regulations of the University. The Standards Committee is established both to assure a proper review of student complaints and at the same time to protect faculty from nuisance appeals on marks.

The Standards Committee is to be formed by the Higher Education Council. A student representative sits in the Committee.

XII. Language Policy

A. Bilingualism

In keeping our legitimate national aspiration, XU's policy is bilingualism which promotes proficiency in both English and Filipino. While vocabulary borrowing is bound to occur, there should be an attempt to keep each language faithful to its own inner spirit and to prefer the apt to the borrowed word. There must never be mixing of language structure, sometimes called "code switching" which prevents mastery of either language and is often an indication of sloppy thinking. In fact, true bilingualism is mastery of both languages that no need is felt to keep switching from one language to the other.

Proficiency in both languages (or even in a third language) does not necessarily mean that the two be given equal school time. The main principles determining which language should be used in a particular subject should depend on which language here and now is the most conducive to mastery of the subject matter. Clearly, English subjects should be taught in English and Filipino subjects in Filipino. As for the rest, the necessity and the availability of textbooks and journals (and teachers) will have a part in the decision of which to use in class.

Classes must be taught in one language. Students in a Filipino conducted class are expected to speak entirely in Filipino. English borrowing is accepted when necessary or when dictated by sense.
There is no intention to kill the native language (Inang Wika) of non-Tagalog students. The fact is that many of the students especially here in Mindanao, will turn out to be truly multi-linguals: English, Filipino and the native language (Cebuano-Visayan, Ilongo, etc.). They are also encouraged to learn foreign languages for which there are facilities provided on campus.

B. Objectives

The language and literature courses have two distinct objectives to accomplish: first, to impart certain thinking and communication skills and second, to form the minds of the students through contact with the best literature. The two objectives may be conceived as the form and the content of what the old Ratio called Eloquentia.

C. Skills

The basic skills that have to be acquired are the following:

1. Reading, writing, listening and speaking
2. Clear thinking, analysis and inference
3. Intuition, creativity, synthesis

These skills are themselves the basic tools when studying in college. The skills and habit of reading form the basis of any learning in Science and Philosophy as well as of any further intellectual growth after graduation.
The skill much emphasized in Jesuit education is that of expression and in the traditional Ratio, this took the form of public speaking. Debates, plays, poetry readings, etc. have always been encouraged even as part of curricular activity, the emphasis mainly on the spoken word. The times today may point to other forms of expression, such as electronic media. But the emphasis on expression and on training in expression remains as urgent. Expressiveness is a mark of the Jesuit alumnus.

Language proficiency, as the basis of expression, has always been important. Much of the proficiency in English of former Jesuit students came from practice in

translating the Latin classics into modern English through acquiring a feel for the nuances of language and sense of “style.”

Today, language teachers can take advantage of the bilingualism of the students by having them translate from one into the other, always insisting that the translation rings true culturally, as if it were originally created in that language. Feel for the language will mean greater ability to work
within the culture and be effective in it.

D. Content

Besides training in style, a study of literature for its content can be truly humanizing since it places the student in contact with the greatest minds of the human race through the written word.

By entering into the experience of fellow humans, some living in ages very di`erent from our own but caught like us in limitations of culture, one gains insights into one’s own situation and can in a true sense be liberated and educated.

Thus, as part of regular class work or simply for pleasure, the student is encouraged to read Western and Asian authors side by side with Filipino authors. Leisure for reading is the privilege of a relative few yet it almost becomes a duty for those few to bring the culture of other times and other places to their own native land.

XIII. Institutional Requirements

A. Orientation Seminar (ORSEM). The orientation seminar is required for all new undergraduate students in the University. The seminar which runs for three days aims to introduce new students to the mission, vision and policies of the University. Proper orientation clearance from the Office of Student A`airs has to be obtained before new students can claim their University ID. Delayed orientation is held during the first week of regular classes for those who were not able to attend the regular orientation due to legitimate reason. Those required to attend the delayed orientation will be marked absent from the classes they will miss.

The second semester orientation is held during the first week of regular classes and is patterned after the delayed orientation format. The orientation of graduate students is conducted by their respective Program Directors or Deans.

B. Ignatian Culture and Mission (IDE 10.1) – This is a required Interdisciplinary Elective 1 for all programs. In this course, the students are introduced to the di<erent themes of Ignatian culture and its mission. They are led to understand and appreciate heritage, tradition, values, attitudes, spirituality, leadership, involvement and service. The students are invited to take on the challenge to nurture a life of discernment, prayer and service of God, others, society and the world.

C. Physical Education (PE) Program. All students are required to take and pass four units of basic PE during the first two years.

1. Only one basic PE subject may be taken in a semester.
2. No student is exempted from PE program. Physically-handicapped students are assigned activities suited for their conditions.

D. National Service Training Program (NSTP). In conformity with government regulations, XU requires all students to register for two semesters of NSTP during the regular enrollment period. Graduates of the Literacy Training Service (LTS) and Civic Welfare Training Service

(CWTS) are organized into the National Service Reserve Corps (NSRC). NSRC Reservists are required to physically register in their respective schools/barangays of residence and secure a school/barangay certification that s/he is registered and accounted for. The said certification is a requirement for college/program graduation.

E. Recollections and Retreat Requirements

1. XU is committed to the faith development of its students. This is in accord with the educational philosophy that education is to contribute to the full formation of the human person engaging him/her not only intellectually, but as well as ethically, psychologically and spiritually.
2. For reflection on ethical, moral and religious truths and practice, with the thrust of forming its students to be holistic, integrated persons of faith, XU requires certain number of recollections and retreats for all undergraduate college students. The recollections and retreats are facilitated by the Campus Ministries OMce (CMO) in coordination with the Department of Religious Studies (RS) and other formation units in the University.
3. The formation program is applicable to all students under the baccalaureate, graduate and professional programs.
4. Students in every level should go through the experience of the spiritual formation through the recollections and retreats and the Graduate School students should have at least two spiritual formation sessions.
5. All undergraduate students of XU are required to undergo two live-in retreats (Junior and Senior's Retreat).
6. In the conduct of the recollection and retreat, students who are not Catholics are not required to attend the specifically Catholic liturgies in regard to Sacraments of Reconciliation and the Eucharist. However, while not attending these Catholic rites, they will have their separate prayer sessions designed and implemented by CMO in consultation with the students' appropriate church leaders. In sum, as XU is concerned with the activities for full human formation of its Catholic students, it is concerned as well with the same fullness of value formation for all who choose to take its educational programs without proselytizing. In the spirit of inter-faith and economical dialogue, the University avoids and discourages proselytizing by any group.

F. Other Requirements. Other requirements may be announced by the University through the appropriate oMces. College Deans and Department Chairs shall regularly guide the students in the fulfilment of their academic requirements.

XIV. Final Provisions

1. The Policy. All students are held responsible for knowing the policies and regulations contained in the Basic Academic Policies of this Student Handbook.

2. Separability Clause. If any provision of the Basic Academic Policies is declared invalid, the remainder thereof shall be in full force or effect.

3. Effectivity. The provisions of the Basic Academic Policies will take e`ect only after this document is duly approved by the President upon consultation with the appropriate body designated by the President.

4. Amendments. These policies can only be amended every school year after the end of the second semester of its ratification.